

The Heart Dhāraṇī of Śākyamuni

Śākyamunihr̥dayadhāraṇī · Toh 860 · Derge Kangyur

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The Heart Dhāraṇī of Śākyamuni, Toh 860 in the Kangyur, is a very short text devoted to the buddha Śākyamuni. Its Sanskrit title is probably close to Śākyamuni-hr̥daya-dhāraṇī, though the exact Sanskrit and Tibetan titles are not given in the lines available here. After a homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha Śākyamuni, the text presents a brief mantra, "oṃ muni muni mahāmunaye svāhā," which plays on the epithet muni, "sage." It then promises that reciting it even once purifies every negative deed accumulated over an immense number of eons. In the Kangyur it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, those compact formulas of recitation that are gathered within the Tantra division and valued for their protective and purifying power.

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha Śākyamuni.

Tadyathā, oṃ muni muni mahāmunaye svāhā.

If one recites this even once, every negative deed one has committed over eighty thousand times a hundred koṭis of eons will be purified.

This completes the Noble Heart Dhāraṇī of Śākyamuni.

Translator's Notes

- A koṭi is ten million, so the stated span is eighty thousand times one hundred koṭis of eons. The Tibetan spelling of the mantra, ma hā mu na ye, is normalized here to the Sanskrit dative mahāmunaye.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.